ence, etc., and lead to their subordination to authority? No. As Śaṅkara himself says, "Scriptures cannot be acknowledged to refute that which is settled by other means of right knowledge."[4] Besides, the agreement sought here is not between inference and authority, i.e., between one means of knowledge and another, but between the reasoning of a higher and a lower mind. Even at the level of perception or reasoning, we always measure and seek agreement between our reasoning and that of those better trained and skilled than ourselves. We always compare lower reasoning with higher reasoning. We do not seek correspondence between our inferences and those of children, imbeciles, and idiots. Among reasonable people also, what is reasonable to one man is not so to another, and we seek to tally our rational conclusion with those recognized to be the most perfect in the field. There is thus no subordination of reason to authority—but only of lower reason to higher reason, and it is difficult to see how one can object to this distinction and practice in general, even though we may not agree as to the particular person or persons who possess a more rational or perfect mind. Those in India, therefore, who deny the authority of the Vedas refuse to believe them as the knowledge of minds higher than their own. In fact, the Cārvākas called the Vedas the prattlings of insane minds. That, however, is not the same as disbelief in the word of a reliable person.

As to the recognition of testimony as a means of valid knowledge, no question has even seemed to have arisen in India. That we actually know and learn by testimony is a matter of indubitable fact, and thus it is as valid as any other source, such as perception. The only objection raised in India against testimony has been on the score of its independence, i.e., that knowledge by testimony is not an independent source of knowledge, but is a variety of perception or inference. There is no need, therefore, for the recognition of authority as a separate source of knowledge, and this is the second reason why Western philosophy may also deny authority. This argument is discussed at length,[5] and it is conclusively established that knowledge by verbal or written testimony cannot be included in the category of sensation and ideation, for it does not possess the differentia of perception or inference. Perception requires that the senses be in contact with an external object, and this is not so in the case of testimony, for, when a word is apprehended, it is the inner meaning and not the outer sound which is the object of knowledge. Similarly, it is contended that, for lack of a middle term and "universal concomitance," testimony cannot be classed as inference. Also, there is no such positive thing pres-